

Connecting Claude to NetSuite: Admin Setup Guide

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This guide walks a NetSuite administrator through setting up Claude to query NetSuite data via the Model Context Protocol (MCP). It covers the NetSuite-side configuration (features, role, OAuth integration), the Claude-side connection, and a brief security checklist.

What this enables

Once configured, users can ask Claude natural-language questions about NetSuite data — trial balances, transaction detail, AP balances, vendor activity — and Claude will query NetSuite directly and return results. Users with appropriate role permissions can also draft journal entries and other records.

The integration uses NetSuite’s native MCP support and standard REST Web Services. No third-party middleware required.

Prerequisites

- NetSuite account with administrator access
 - A Claude account on a tier that supports MCP connectors
 - ~30 minutes for setup, plus testing time
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Part A: NetSuite setup

A.1 Enable required features

Setup → Company → Enable Features → SuiteCloud tab. Confirm these are enabled:

- REST Web Services
- OAuth 2.0

Save and acknowledge any prompts.

A.2 Confirm the MCP SuiteApp is installed

NetSuite exposes the MCP endpoint via a SuiteApp. Customization → SuiteBundler → Search & Install Bundles. Search for “MCP” to verify whether the standard tools bundle is already installed. If not, install it.

After install, your MCP endpoint will follow this pattern:

`https://[ACCOUNT_ID].suitetalk.api.netsuite.com/services/mcp/v1/suite`

Replace [ACCOUNT_ID] with your NetSuite account ID (visible in your account URL). Sandbox accounts will use the appropriate sandbox subdomain.

A.3 Create the integration role

Setup → Users/Roles → Manage Roles → New. Name it something explicit like “AI Connector” or “Claude MCP.”

Setup subtab — required for the connection itself: - MCP Server Connection — Full - Log in using OAuth 2.0 Access Tokens — Full - REST Web Services — Full

Reports subtab: - SuiteAnalytics Workbook — Edit (or View if users shouldn’t save workbooks) - View on the financial reports you want exposed

Lists subtab: - View on the lists you want exposed (Accounts, Vendors, Customers, Items, Subsidiaries, etc.) - Documents and Files — View (avoid Full, which permits deletion of cabinet files)

Transactions subtab: - View on the transaction types you want exposed - Make Journal Entry — Create if Claude should be able to draft JEs; otherwise View - Do not grant Approve Journal unless you want Claude to release JEs without human review

Do not grant any of these: - Manage Users, Manage Roles, Manage Permissions - SuiteScript, SuiteFlow, Workflow Manager - Accounting Preferences - Bundle Installation - Override Period Restrictions - Period Closing Management - Set Up Year Status - Custom Record Types or Custom Fields at Edit/Full level

These either let the role escalate its own privileges or bypass foundational controls (period close, JE approval routing). LLM-driven roles should never have them.

A.4 Subsidiary scope (OneWorld accounts only)

On the role’s main page, under **Subsidiary Restrictions:**

- Set to **Selected** and pick only the subsidiaries the role should access
- Uncheck **Allow Cross-Subsidiary Record Viewing**

If you have multiple regional teams, prefer one role per subsidiary group over one broadly-scoped role. Cloning a base role and adjusting the subsidiary list per region is faster than maintaining custom restrictions.

A.5 Authentication settings on the role

- Two-Factor Authentication Required: **Required**
- Web Services Only Role: **unchecked** (so users can still verify data in the NetSuite UI)
- Restrict by Device ID: optional, recommended if you have stable user devices or office IP ranges
- Accounting Books: **Primary** unless you specifically need secondary book access

A.6 Create an OAuth 2.0 integration record

Setup → Integrations → Manage Integrations → New.

- Name: “Claude MCP” or similar
- State: Enabled
- Authentication: check **OAuth 2.0**
- Scope: **REST Web Services**
- Redirect URI: provided by Claude during the connection flow. Check Claude’s connector documentation for the current value, or complete the flow once and capture the URI from the redirect

Save. NetSuite generates a **Consumer Key** and **Consumer Secret** and shows them once. Store both in a password manager — you cannot retrieve them later.

A.7 Assign the role to test users

Setup → Users/Roles → Manage Users → select user → Access subtab → add the role. Save. Start with your own user for testing.

Part B: Claude setup

1. Open Claude (Desktop or web)
 2. Go to Settings → Connectors
 3. Look for **NetSuite** in the connector list. If it’s not present, add a custom MCP server using the endpoint URL from A.2
 4. Click **Connect**
 5. Provide the endpoint URL, Consumer Key, and Consumer Secret when prompted
 6. A browser window opens and redirects to NetSuite for OAuth consent
 7. Sign in (with a user who has the role from A.3), complete 2FA, and approve consent
 8. You’ll be returned to Claude with the connection active
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Part C: Verification

In a new Claude chat:

| Show me a list of all subsidiaries I can access in NetSuite.

If you set a subsidiary restriction in A.4, the result should reflect that. If you set the role to access all subsidiaries, you’ll see all of them.

Then try something account-specific:

| Pull the trial balance as of the last day of the current month.

If both work, the setup is complete. If you get a “record not found” or permission error, the role is missing a View permission on the relevant record type — go back to A.3 and add it.

Brief security checklist

Before you assign this role to anyone else:

1. **Subsidiary scope verified** with the query above
2. **JE approval routing enabled** in Accounting Preferences (Setup → Accounting → Accounting Preferences → “Require Approvals on Journal Entries”). Without this, Create permission on JEs combined with the API write path means entries can post unilaterally
3. **No privileged permissions** — re-check the “Do not grant” list in A.3

4. **Per-user OAuth tokens, not shared** — each user authenticates with their own credentials. A shared token means every Claude-driven action shows up under one service account in System Notes, which defeats user-level audit attribution
5. **2FA required** on the role
6. **No Override Period Restrictions** — confirm it's absent. Combined with write permissions, it would let entries post into closed periods

One thing to tell your users

Any action a user takes through Claude that touches NetSuite is logged in NetSuite's System Notes under that user's account. Make sure users know this. Natural language doesn't change accountability — anything they ask Claude to create or modify has their name on it in the audit trail.

UI paths may vary slightly between NetSuite releases. Verify against your account's current Setup menu structure if anything looks different.